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HTML form elements 30m

You can create forms in HTML using the `<form>` element. This element will collect the data the user inputs into the form. The `<form>` element is a container, meaning you'll use other elements within the `<form>` to create things like text fields, drop-down lists and submit buttons.

Input element

The `<input>` element is used to define an input field according to the attributes included in the start tag.

For example, if you wanted your form to have a single-input text field, you'd use the `<input>` element followed by a type attribute to specify text, as shown below.



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HTML

Result

EDIT ON

LIVE

```
<h2>Text input fields</h2>
<form>
  <input type="text">
</form>
```

Text input fields

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Example 5.23 Text input fields



You could also specify a unique identifier by using the `id` attribute while the `name` attribute specifies a name for the input. The `name` attribute is required within the `<input>` element; otherwise, the value of that input field will not be sent.



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HTML

Result

EDIT ON

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```
<h2>Text input fields</h2>
<form>
  <input type="text" id="fname"
name="fname">
</form>
```

Resources1x0.5x0.25xRerun

Example 5.24 Text input fields 2



Other relevant attributes are the `tabindex`, which defines the tab order of the element, and the `value` attribute, which defines an initial value for a field.

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Label element

The `<label>` element is used to define the label of the form elements. The `<label>` element must include the `form` attribute, which should match the `id` attribute mentioned in the `<input>` element.



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HTML

Result

EDIT ON

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```
<h2>Text input fields</h2>
<form>
  <label for="fname">First name:
</label>
  <input type="text" id="fname"
name="fname" >
</form>
```

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Example 5.25 Label



Note how the `for` attribute matches the `id` attribute.

The label element is also used by screen readers to read the labels. This element should always be used in the forms you develop for accessibility.

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Read *HTML forms* (W3Schools, n.d.) to learn about the different forms that can be created in HTML. This article demonstrates how to create radio buttons, checkboxes and submit buttons.

Now that you have explored HTML forms, complete the following task.



☒ HTML forms

Non-Assessed

Status: Done

Reset ↺

Create a survey form that includes checkboxes to allow multiple choices and a submit button to send the form data.

Instructions:

1. Create an HTML file and name it survey.html.
2. Inside the HTML file, set up the basic structure with `<!DOCTYPE html>`, `<html>`, `<head>`, and `<body>` tags.
3. Add a title to your form using the `<h1>` tag.
4. Create a form using the `<form>` tag with the action attribute set to a URL where the form data will be sent (for now, you can use `#` to keep it simple).
5. Inside the form, add a question with multiple checkboxes for the user to select their favourite hobbies.
6. Add a submit button to the form.

☒ I have completed this activity



Did you get that right? Here is what our code looked like: [Task: HTML forms feedback](#). You might have slight variations in how you have

approached this task, but the output should be similar

Previous attempts ▼



Let's now circle back and look at how to apply validation in HTML.



Thoughts on this page?



HTML forms

Share some of your own approaches to designing survey forms. Did you face any challenges? Share any tips, solutions or resources that you found helpful for building effective and appealing forms.

B *I*  

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Jorge Andres Guerrero Giraldo 14 Jan 2026, 9:17 AM

My approach to designing survey forms is to start with the goal and keep the user effort as low as possible. I first list the decisions the survey needs to support, then translate that into only the questions that are necessary. I group questions into short sections with clear headings and a logical flow, from easy questions to more detailed ones. I also select input types that match the data, such as radio buttons for single choice, checkboxes for multiple choice, and select menus only when the list is long.

The main challenges I have faced are balancing completeness with length, ensuring the form works well on mobile, and making validation helpful rather than annoying. Another common issue is clarity: users can misunderstand questions if labels and examples are not specific. To address this, I use concise labels, short helper text where needed, and clear error messages that explain how to fix the issue.

